FRACTURE

WRITTEN BY

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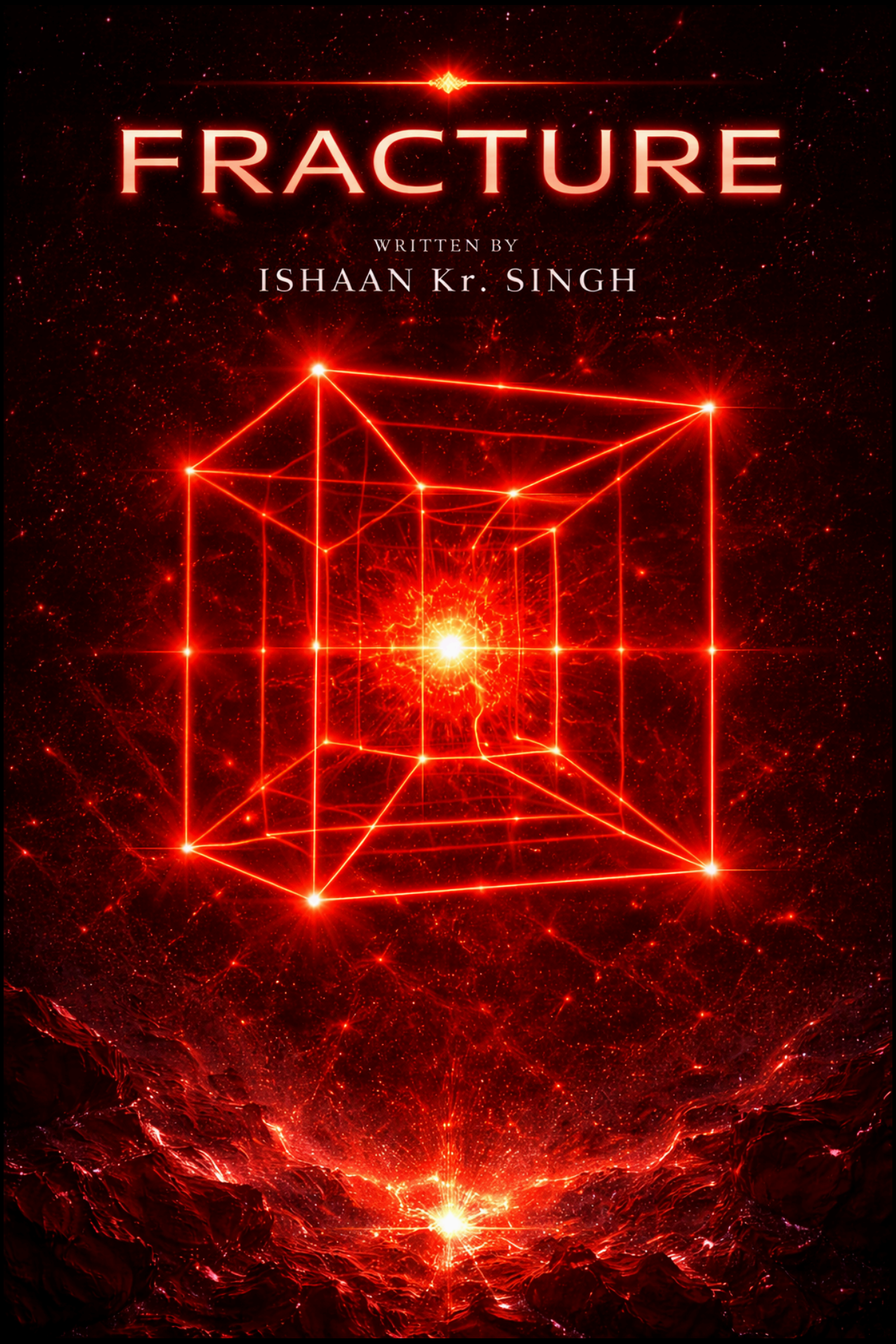

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Chapter 1: The Architecture of Loneliness

NASA ke un chamakte corridors se nikal kar jab Ishaan wapas India aaya, toh logon ko laga wo ek 'Vijayayee Laut' (victorious return) hai. Par Ishaan ke liye, ye sirf ek bhaag-daur thi. Usne apni company **IKS (Ishaan Kinetic Systems)** ki neev rakhi. Building vishal thi, glass aur steel se bani hui, par uske andar ka sannata usse bhi bada tha.

Ishaan ab aksar apni lab ki khidki se baahar dekhta rehta. Wo log jo use 'God' kehte the, wo nahi jaante the ki ye 'God' raat ko sota nahi hai. Professor Kenji America ja chuke the, par unki rozana ki video calls Ishaan ke liye ek sahara thi.

"Ishaan, tumne khud ko ek qile mein band kar liya hai," Kenji aksar kehte.

Ishaan sirf muskura deta. Wo Kenji ko kaise batata ki use darr lagta tha... darr ki agar wo ruka, toh use wo sab yaadein gher lengi jo wo peeche chhodna chahta tha.

Idhar Avika ne apna CA clear kar liya tha. Wo ab ek safal career ki taraf badh rahi thi, par uska dil wahi pichli seat waale Ishaan ke paas atka tha. Uske gharwale jab shaadi ke liye ladko ki tasveerein dikhate, wo unhe dekhti tak nahi. Uske liye 'Cyber-God' Ishaan nahi, balki wo 'Invisible' Ishaan zinda tha. Wo intezar kar rahi thi... ki shayad kisi din, wo ladka apne code aur machines se bahar nikal kar use waisa hi dekhega jaise school ki bus mein dekhta tha.

Chapter 2: The Bleeding Skies

Sukoon ek kaanch ki deewar nikla, jo ek hi pal mein chaknachoor ho gayi.

Ek dopehar, aasmaan ka rang achanak badalne laga. Neela rang dheere-dheere ek gehre, gande laal (Crimson) mein badal gaya. Aur phir... dararein padne lagi. Poori duniya mein achanak ajeeb se **Red Portals** khulne lage. Ye portals aasmaan mein kisi khule hue zakhm ki tarah lag rahe the.

Kahin ye ek angoothi ke size ke the, toh kahin itne vishal ki unki garjan se dharti kaanp uthti thi. NASA ne report kiya ki Jupiter ka ek chaand (moon) ek aise hi portal mein sama gaya—jaise kisi ne use aasmaan se mita diya ho.

IKS ke inauguration ke din, Ishaan stage par tha. Usne abhi bolna shuru hi kiya tha ki NASA ke bade officials, kaali gaadiyon mein wahan pahunche. Unhone inauguration ko ek 'Crime Scene' mein badal diya.

"Ishaan, ye portals tumhare Time Travel experiments ka natija hain," unhone poori media ke samne chillakar kaha.

Ishaan ke paas koi jawab nahi tha. Use pata tha ki usne physics ke saath chhed-chhaad ki thi, par kya natija itna bhayanak hoga? Police ne use wahi sabke samne arrest kar liya. Wo haathkadiyan Ishaan ke haathon par nahi, uske bharose par lagi thi.

Chapter 3: The Cage and the Cradle

Jail ki thandi aur silan bhari deewaron ke beech Ishaan baitha tha. Baahar bheed uske khoon ki pyaasi thi, use 'Universe ka Qatil' keh rahi thi. Tabhi, wahan Avika pahunchi. Usne bina kuch bole Ishaan ke haath ko pakda—uska haath barf ki tarah thanda tha.

"Bhuvan bhai kahan hain?" Ishaan ne bahut dhire se pucha.

"Wo Mikhail ko hospital le gaya hai," Avika ki aankhon mein nami thi. "Mikhail ko achanak chakkar aur ultiyan aane lagi thi. Wo pareshan hai, Ishaan."

Jitendar ne apni poori sifarish lagayi aur Ishaan ko bail mil gayi. Lab pahunchte hi Bhuvan ka phone aaya. Uski awaaz mein aansu the, par wo khushi ke the.

"Ishaan... Mikhail pregnant hai! Main... main baap banne wala hoon!"

Ishaan ki aankhon mein ek pal ke liye chamak aayi, usne muskurakar badhai di. Par jaise hi usne phone rakha, usne baahar laal aasmaan ko dekha. Ek nayi zindagi janam lene wali thi, aur poora universe maut ki kagaar par tha. Wo muskurahat ek darr mein badal gayi.

Chapter 4: The Dimensional Nexus

Professor Kenji agle hi din India pahunch gaye. Lab mein andhera tha, sirf monitor ki laal roshni unke chehron par pad rahi thi. Ishaan ne screen par ek complex mathematical model dikhaya.

"Sir, hamara multiverse ab tak ek 4D Sphere ki tarah balance mein tha," Ishaan ne kaha, uski awaaz mein ek thandak thi. "Par SAHAY ke sensors bata rahe hain ki ab ye ek 4D Cube, yaani **Dimensional Nexus** mein badal chuka hai. Ye natural nahi hai, sir. Koi hume is nexus ke beech mein kheench raha hai... jaise koi makkhi ko jaale mein kheencha jata hai."

Mikhail ki halat aur Kenji ki dhal rahi umra dekh kar Ishaan ne unhe rukne ka faisla sunaya. Usne 'Waqt Rath' ko portals ke layak update kiya. Ishaan aur Avika ne ek-doosre ki taraf dekha. Unhe pata tha ye safar shayad unka aakhri ho. Ship ne jaise hi portal mein entry li, ek bhayanak jhatke ne unhe space-time ke us paar phek diya.

Chapter 5: Shadow of the Abyss

Jab Ishaan ki aankh khuli, toh har taraf mitti aur dhuaan tha. Ship crash ho chuki thi. "Avika!" wo chillaya, par uski awaaz kisi gehre kuyein mein kho gayi.

Ye ek aisa universe tha jahan suraj kabhi nikalta hi nahi tha. Har taraf demons aur pishachon ka raj tha. Dhund mein se ek char-pair wala bhayanak rakshas Avika ki taraf jhapta. Ishaan ne bina soche Astra Ring se **'Talwar'** banayi—ek neeli bijli chamki aur us rakshas ka sar zameen par tha.

Wahan unhe ek purani, tooti hui lab mili jahan se halki roshni aa rahi thi. Wahan ek shaks baitha tha, jiske chehre par sadiyon ki thakan thi. Usne Ishaan ko dekhte hi uske pair chhuye.

"Aap zinda hain?" wo hairan tha. "Mera naam **Om** hai. Mere universe mein ek virus (SAJ-26) se ladte hue aap... yaani mere universe ke Ishaan, shaheed ho gaye the. Hum bache hue log yahan underground rehte hain."

Ishaan aur Om ne poori raat kaam kiya. Unhe pata tha ship ab udne layak nahi hai. Unhone milkar do wrist devices banayi—**'Waqt-Bandh'**. Ye portable portal machines thi, jo unhe Dimensional Nexus ke center tak le ja sakti thi.

Chapter 6: The Mirror of Malice

Ishaan aur Avika 'Waqt-Bandh' ka istemal karke Dimensional Nexus ke bilkul beech (center) mein pahunche. Wahan koi zameen nahi thi, sirf ek anant (infinite) safed roshni thi aur charo taraf multiverse ke alag-alag nazare aise tair rahe the jaise kisi ne kaanch ka burtan tod diya ho.

Aur wahan khada tha—**Manvik**.

Par ye wo Manvik nahi tha jise Ishaan ne pichli baar dekha tha. Is Manvik ki aankhon mein ek aisi thandak thi jo sirf karoron saal ka akelapan hi de sakta hai. Uske haath mein ek ajeeb sa **'Trishul'** tha, jo kisi metal se nahi balki jam chuki energy se bana lag raha tha.

"Tumhe lagta hai tum special ho, Ishaan?" Manvik ki awaaz pure Nexus mein goonji. "Maine past mein ja kar us nanhe Ishaan ke dimaag ko absorb karne ki koshish ki thi, par wo kamzor baccha... wo maut ke darr se hi mar gaya. Mera plan fail ho gaya, par meri bhookh nahi."

Manvik dhire-dheere unki taraf badha. "Maine rukne ke bajaye har multiverse ke us kamzor Ishaan ko dhoonda, use maara aur uski intelligence chheen li. Aaj mere andar laakhon 'Ishaans' ka dimaag hai. **Main hi asli Ishaan hoon!**"

Ishaan ne Astra Ring ko ghumaya aur use ek vishalkay **'Gada'** mein badal diya, par Manvik ne sirf apni ungli se ishara kiya. Uske Trishul se ek aisi bhayanak energy wave nikli jisne space-time ko hi phaad diya. Ishaan aur Avika ek gehre andhere portal mein ja gire.

Chapter 7: The War Universe

Jab dono ki aankh khuli, toh unke kano mein dhamako ki awaaz pad rahi thi. Wo ek aise universe mein the jahan shayad sadiyon se yudh (war) chal raha tha. Aasmaan kaala tha aur zameen par sirf baarood aur lohe ke dher the.

Ishaan aur Avika ek tabah ho chuki building ke sahare bhag rahe the. Charo taraf se missiles aur drones ki awaazein aa rahi thi. "Ishaan, hume yahan se nikalna hoga!" Avika chillayi, uska chehra dhool aur paseene se bhara tha.

"Waqt-Bandh activate karo!" Ishaan ne chillakar kaha, jab wo ek girti hui deewar se bache.

Dono ek tang gali mein mude, par tabhi unke upar ek vishalkay building, jo pehle hi adh-tooti thi, dhire-dheere jhukne lagi. Avika ne darte hue apne wrist device (Waqt-Bandh) par haath rakha, par darr aur paseene ki wajah se uska haath thirak gaya. Device uski kalai se phisal kar door malbe mein ja gira.

"Ishaan! Mera device...!" Avika ki awaaz mein wo darr tha jo Ishaan ne aaj se pehle kabhi nahi suna tha.

Chapter 8: The Fracture

Ishaan ne peeche mudkar dekha. Building ke girne ki raftar tez ho gayi thi. Wo Avika ki taraf jhapatne hi wala tha, par malba unke beech mein kisi pahad ki tarah girne laga.

"ISHAANNN!"

Avika ki wo aakhri pukar thi, jo sadiyon tak Ishaan ke kano mein goonjne wali thi. Agle hi pal, ton-bhari concrete aur lohe ki salaakhon ne Avika ko apne niche daba liya. Charo taraf sirf dhool ka gubbar tha.

"AVIKAAA!" Ishaan cheekha. Wo pagalpan mein malbe ko apne hathon se hatane laga. Uske nakhun toot gaye, hathon se khoon nikalne laga, par wo ruk nahi raha tha.

Jab dhool hati, toh use malbe ke neeche se Avika ka ek haath dikha. Wo thanda pad chuka tha. Us haath mein wahi bracelet tha jo Ishaan ne use gift kiya tha—jisne kabhi Nebula ki roshni dikhayi thi, wo ab khoon se laal ho chuka tha.

Ishaan ne us thande haath ko apne chehre se lagaya aur wahi baith gaya. Wo ro nahi raha tha... uski aankhein khali thi. Uska multiverse wahi khatam ho gaya tha.

Chapter 9: The Aftermath

Lab ka portal achanak neeli roshni ke saath khula. Bhuvan, Mikhail aur Kenji umeed se uski taraf daude. Par jab unhone Ishaan ko dekha, toh unke qadam wahi ruk gaye.

Ishaan thaka-haara tha, uska kapde phate hue the, aur uske poore sharir par mitti aur sookha hua khoon tha. Uske haath mein Avika ka wo bracelet tha.

"Ishaan... Avika kahan hai?" Bhuvan ne kaanpti awaaz mein pucha.

Ishaan ne koi jawab nahi diya. Uski aankhein pathra chuki thi, jaise usne kuch aisa dekh liya ho jise insaani dimaag bayaan nahi kar sakta. Wo khamoshi se un sabke beech se nikal gaya. Uske chalne ki awaaz mein wo pehle wala confidence nahi tha, sirf ek thakaan thi.

Wo apne room mein gaya aur darwaza andar se band kar liya.

Poori lab mein sannata chha gaya. Kuch der baad, darwaze ke peeche se siskiyon (sobbing) ki awaaz aane lagi. Wo koi aam rona nahi tha... wo ek aise insaan ki awaaz thi jiska sab kuch chheen liya gaya ho. Mikhail ne Bhuvan ka haath pakad liya, dono ki aankhon mein aansu the. Unhe samajh aa gaya tha ki portals toh shayad band ho jayein, par Ishaan ke andar jo 'fracture' hua hai, wo kabhi nahi bharega.